

HOUSE JOINT RESOLUTION 765

By Vital

A RESOLUTION to honor the service of the Ingle family of Hamilton County.

WHEREAS, it is fitting that the members of this General Assembly should salute the valiant individuals who devote themselves to providing essential services to those throughout their community; and

WHEREAS, the Ingle family of Hamilton County has a distinguished legacy of generational service to those throughout the region, selflessly giving of their time and placing their own lives in peril to ensure the safety of others; and

WHEREAS, the Ingle family's story has been intertwined with the Hamilton County Special Tactics and Rescue Services team for decades, with four members of the family currently serving on the volunteer team, which supplements police, fire, and emergency medical services on some of the county's most demanding incidents; and

WHEREAS, headquartered in Harrison, the Hamilton County Special Tactics and Rescue team is currently led by Chief Clay Ingle, whose father, Clyde Morris "Shot" Ingle, previously led the team; the elder Ingle gave his life in the line of duty, succumbing to a heart attack he had while on call; and

WHEREAS, Hamilton County Special Tactics and Rescue was founded on February 3, 1983, as a state-chartered, volunteer rescue agency to respond to a wide range of calls—from missing children and wandering elders to swift-water incidents and natural disaster response; and

WHEREAS, Chief Clay Ingle recalls the day the agency was founded, which was the same day he filled out his application to join the team; he currently serves alongside his sister, son, and daughter; and

WHEREAS, the Ingles were there from the hardscrabble early days of the agency, when, before a headquarters existed, equipment was stored at members' houses, and monthly meetings were held at a local restaurant; when a headquarters was established in 2012, members would regularly cut the utilities off to save power whenever possible; and

WHEREAS, over the ensuing decades, the Ingle family has helped Hamilton County Special Tactics and Rescue Services grow and thrive to a team of approximately fifty members; today, the agency operates two stations and has received various grants and funding initiatives that have helped purchase necessities, such as a command assistance van and a water rescue and firefighting boat; and

WHEREAS, members of the Ingle family have devoted long hours and often sacrificed time together on holidays to ensure the safety or safe recovery of individuals in peril; they have volunteered their time while maintaining full-time employment, answering an average of between seventy-five and ninety calls annually, which can take as long as a few hours to a few days; and

WHEREAS, beyond the rescue agency, Ingle family members have served their community through careers in law enforcement, firefighting, and nursing; and

WHEREAS, throughout the rescue agency's history, from its longtime leaders to the team's first death on call, Ingles have made volunteerism and search-and-rescue part of their family's identity; and

WHEREAS, the Ingle family has exhibited a singular devotion to serving others; they are truly dedicated to the well-being of their fellow Tennesseans, and for their prodigious efforts on behalf of the people of this State, they should be recognized; now, therefore,

BE IT RESOLVED BY THE HOUSE OF REPRESENTATIVES OF THE ONE HUNDRED FOURTEENTH GENERAL ASSEMBLY OF THE STATE OF TENNESSEE, THE SENATE CONCURRING, that we honor and commend the members of the Ingle family, salute their

legacy of selfless service to the good people of Hamilton County, and extend our best wishes for much continued success in their future endeavors.

BE IT FURTHER RESOLVED, that an appropriate copy of this resolution be prepared for presentation with this final clause omitted from such copy and upon proper request made to the appropriate clerk, the language appearing immediately following the State seal appear without House or Senate designation.